

AI Front Desk Helper — Booking API Integration Guide

Version 1.0 · For developers and CRM/platform integrators

Overview

This guide describes how to integrate with the AI Front Desk Helper Booking API. It lets an external system — a CRM, a partner platform, or an AI agent — **check a business's open appointment slots** and **create real bookings** on that business's calendar.

A booking created through this API is a *real* booking. It is identical to one created by the business's own AI receptionist: it reserves the time slot, creates the customer record, sends the customer a confirmation by text and email, and adds the appointment to the business's calendar. There is no separate "API booking" that behaves differently — the appointment lands exactly where the business already manages their work.

There are two ways to integrate, and they expose the same capabilities:

- **REST API** — standard HTTPS requests. Best for most CRM and backend integrations.
- **MCP Server** — a Model Context Protocol endpoint for AI agent platforms that speak MCP. Best when an AI assistant needs to discover and call booking as a tool.

Both are backed by the same booking system. Pick whichever fits your platform; you do not need both.

Before you start: what you need

To integrate, you need two values, both available from the business's AI Front Desk Helper dashboard:

VALUE	WHAT IT IS	WHERE IT'S USED
Business ID	A unique identifier for the business (a UUID).	In the URL path of every request.
API Key	A secret key that authorizes booking creation for this business.	In the request headers when creating a booking.

Keep the API Key secret. It authorizes the creation of real appointments and the sending of real messages to customers. Treat it like a password — store it server-side, never expose it in client-side code, browser apps, or public repositories.

Throughout this guide, replace `{BUSINESS_ID}` with the business's ID and `{API_KEY}` with their key.

The base URL for all requests is:

`https://api.aifrontdeskhelper.com`

Authentication

Authentication uses the business's **API Key**, supplied in the request headers. Two header formats are accepted — use whichever your platform prefers:

`Authorization: Bearer {API_KEY}`

or

`x-api-key: {API_KEY}`

Not every endpoint requires the key:

- **Checking availability is public.** It returns only open time slots — nothing sensitive — so no key is required to read availability.
- **Creating a booking requires the key.** It writes data and sends real messages to a customer, so it must be authorized.

REST API

1. Check availability

Returns the open appointment slots for a business.

```
GET /api/v1/availability/{BUSINESS_ID}
```

Authentication: None required (public).

Query parameters

PARAMETER	REQUIRED	DESCRIPTION
<code>date</code>	Optional	A specific day to check, formatted <code>YYYY-MM-DD</code> .
<code>duration</code>	Optional	Appointment length in minutes. Defaults to <code>60</code> .

Behavior:

- **If you provide `date`** , the response returns that single day's open slots.
- **If you omit `date`** , the API scans upcoming days and returns the next several days (up to 7) that have openings — useful for "what's open this week" without knowing a specific date.

Example — a specific day

```
curl "https://api.aifrontdeskhelper.com/api/v1/availability/{BUSINESS_ID}?date=2026-07-15&duration=60"
```

Response (**200 OK**):

```
{
  "ok": true,
  "tenant": { "id": "{BUSINESS_ID}", "name": "Example Painting Co" },
  "date": "2026-07-15",
  "duration_minutes": 60,
  "slots": [
    { "value": "09:00:00", "time": "9:00 AM" },
    { "value": "13:00:00", "time": "1:00 PM" },
    { "value": "15:00:00", "time": "3:00 PM" }
  ]
}
```

Each slot has two fields:

- **value** — the machine value (e.g. `"09:00:00"`). **This is what you pass to the booking endpoint.**
- **time** — a human-friendly label (e.g. `"9:00 AM"`) for display to a person.

Example — scan upcoming days

```
curl "https://api.aifrontdeskhelper.com/api/v1/availability/{BUSINESS_ID}"
```

Response (**200 OK**):

```
{
  "ok": true,
  "tenant": { "id": "{BUSINESS_ID}", "name": "Example Painting Co" },
  "duration_minutes": 60,
  "days": [
    {
      "date": "2026-07-15",
      "slots": [
        { "value": "09:00:00", "time": "9:00 AM" },
        { "value": "13:00:00", "time": "1:00 PM" }
      ]
    },
    {
      "date": "2026-07-16",
      "slots": [
        { "value": "10:00:00", "time": "10:00 AM" }
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

2. Create a booking

Creates a real appointment.

```
POST /api/v1/booking/{BUSINESS_ID}
```

Authentication: Required — `Authorization: Bearer {API_KEY}` or `x-api-key: {API_KEY}` .

Request body (JSON)

FIELD	REQUIRED	DESCRIPTION
date	Yes	Appointment date, YYYY-MM-DD .
time	Yes	A slot value returned by the availability endpoint (e.g. "09:00:00").
duration_minutes	Optional	Appointment length. Defaults to 60 .
contact.name	Yes	Customer's full name.
contact.phone	Yes	Customer's phone number.
contact.email	Yes	Customer's email address (must be valid).
contact.address	Yes	Service address (street, city, ZIP).
project_type	Optional	Type of project or service.
project_details	Optional	Additional detail about the job.
estimated_value	Optional	Estimated job value, in dollars. If supplied, the booking records this value.

All four contact fields are required — name, phone, email, and address. This is the same information the business collects on every booking through every channel, so the appointment is complete and actionable.

Example request

```
curl -X POST "https://api.aifrontdeskhelper.com/api/v1/booking/{BUSINESS_ID}" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer {API_KEY}" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{
  "date": "2026-07-15",
  "time": "09:00:00",
  "duration_minutes": 60,
  "contact": {
    "name": "Jordan Smith",
    "phone": "+14025551234",
    "email": "jordan@example.com",
    "address": "123 Main St, Omaha, NE 68102"
  },
  "project_type": "Interior painting",
  "project_details": "Two bedrooms and a hallway",
  "estimated_value": 2400
}'
```

Success response (200 OK)

```
{
  "ok": true,
  "booking_id": "b1f2c3d4-...",
  "lead_id": "a9b8c7d6-...",
  "date": "2026-07-15",
  "time": "09:00:00",
  "tenant": { "id": "{BUSINESS_ID}", "name": "Example Painting Co" }
}
```

On success, the customer is automatically sent a confirmation, and the appointment appears on the business's calendar and dashboard. No further calls are needed.

Error handling (REST)

Every error response has the shape `{ "ok": false, "error": "<code>", ... }` . The HTTP status tells you the category; the `error` code tells you the specific reason.

HTTP STATUS	ERROR CODE	MEANING & WHAT TO DO
401	missing_api_key	No key was provided on a booking request. Add the <code>Authorization</code> or <code>x-api-key</code> header.
403	invalid_api_key	The key was provided but is wrong for this business. Check the key and Business ID match.
404	tenant_not_found	The Business ID in the URL doesn't exist. Verify the ID.
409	slot_taken	The slot was booked by someone else between your availability check and your booking call. Re-check availability and pick another slot.
422	validation_failed	The request was understood but a field is missing or invalid. See the <code>details</code> array in the response.
422	day_closed	The business is closed on that date. Choose another day.
422	outside_business_hours	The time falls outside the business's working hours. Choose a time inside their hours.
422	invalid_datetime	The date or time format wasn't understood. Check formatting.
502	availability_lookup_failed / booking_failed	A temporary problem on our side. Retry after a short delay.

A note on `slot_taken` : availability can change between the moment you read it and the moment you book, because other channels (the business's website, phone, and text line) book the same calendar in real time. Always be ready to handle a `409` by re-fetching availability and offering the customer another slot.

Example validation error (`422`)

```
{
  "ok": false,
  "error": "validation_failed",
  "details": [
    "contact.email must be a valid email",
    "contact.address is required"
  ]
}
```

MCP Server

For AI agent platforms that speak the **Model Context Protocol (MCP)**, the same booking capability is exposed as MCP tools. If you're building a standard CRM or backend integration, use the REST API above instead — this section is only for MCP-aware agents.

Connection

Each business has its own MCP endpoint:

```
POST /api/mcp/{BUSINESS_ID}
```

The protocol is **MCP over JSON-RPC 2.0** on a single HTTP endpoint (Streamable HTTP, JSON responses). Supply the business's **API Key** at the transport layer using the `Authorization: Bearer {API_KEY}` or `x-api-key` header on the HTTP request — this keeps the key out of tool arguments and conversation context.

A quick health/discovery probe is available via `GET` on the same path:

```
curl "https://api.aifrontdeskhelper.com/api/mcp/{BUSINESS_ID}"
```

This returns the server info, protocol version, and the list of available tools.

Supported methods

The server implements the core MCP surface an agent needs to connect and call tools: `initialize` , `notifications/initialized` , `tools/list` , `tools/call` , and `ping` .

Tools

`check_availability`

Checks open appointment slots. Public (no key needed).

ARGUMENT	REQUIRED	DESCRIPTION
date	Optional	A specific day, YYYY-MM-DD . Omit to scan upcoming days.
duration_minutes	Optional	Appointment length. Defaults to 60 .

Returns the same slot data as the REST availability endpoint — each slot has a value (pass to create_booking) and a human-friendly time .

create_booking

Creates a real appointment. Requires the API key on the connection.

ARGUMENT	REQUIRED	DESCRIPTION
date	Yes	Appointment date, YYYY-MM-DD .
time	Yes	A slot value from check_availability .
duration_minutes	Optional	Defaults to 60 .
name	Yes	Customer full name.
phone	Yes	Customer phone number.
email	Yes	Customer email address.
address	Yes	Service address.
project_type	Optional	Type of project/service.
project_details	Optional	Extra detail about the job.
estimated_value	Optional	Estimated job value in dollars.

Example: tools/call

```
{
  "jsonrpc": "2.0",
  "id": 1,
  "method": "tools/call",
  "params": {
    "name": "create_booking",
    "arguments": {
      "date": "2026-07-15",
      "time": "09:00:00",
      "name": "Jordan Smith",
      "phone": "+14025551234",
      "email": "jordan@example.com",
      "address": "123 Main St, Omaha, NE 68102",
      "project_type": "Interior painting"
    }
  }
}
```

Tool results are returned as MCP content blocks containing JSON text. A tool-level failure (e.g. a taken slot or a validation problem) is returned with isError: true and a JSON body describing the reason, using the same error codes as the REST API.

Integration checklist

A reliable integration follows this flow:

- Read availability** with GET /api/v1/availability/{BUSINESS_ID} (or the check_availability tool). Show the customer the human-friendly time labels.
- Capture the four required contact fields** — name, phone, email, and address. A booking can't be created without all four.
- Create the booking** with the slot's value (not the display label) and the contact details, including the API key.
- Handle slot_taken (409)** gracefully — re-fetch availability and offer another time. This is normal because the calendar is shared across all of the business's booking channels.
- On success**, you're done — the confirmation to the customer and the calendar entry happen automatically.

Roadmap — additional capabilities on request

The current API covers availability and booking. The following integration capabilities are planned and available on request — if your

integration needs one of these, contact us to discuss timing:

- **Lead sync** — programmatic read access to leads and their status.
- **Status webhooks** — push notifications when a booking is created, rescheduled, completed, or cancelled, so your system stays in sync without polling.
- **Reschedule & cancel endpoints** — modify or cancel an existing booking via the API.
- **Customer lookup** — retrieve a customer's history and prior appointments.

If a specific integration would unlock a deal or a workflow, tell us what you need and we'll prioritize accordingly.

Support

For an API key, a Business ID, or integration help, contact the business's AI Front Desk Helper account owner, or reach AI Front Desk Helper support directly.

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